The Tune in the Tube

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 12

Nib heard a beautiful note through the newly fitted tube. Outside, Lark heard almost nothing. The open end faced the wall. The fitting had made a splendid private concert for one mouse, while the meeting place remained quiet.

“Excellent music in here,” Nib reported proudly. “We would like some of it out there,” Lark replied with amusement.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **ring**

“In cube and mule, u with final silent e can say /yoo/,” Lark modeled clearly. “In flute it says /oo/. Tube may have either familiar pronunciation in ordinary speech. We'll model the word as we say it here, then join its parts without changing its meaning.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try cube, mule, tube, flute. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read tube on the fitting note,” Lark invited warmly. “Which way does the open-end picture face?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam has a tube. I can make a tune.**

“What does Sam have?” Lark asked gently. “What can the speaker make?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

They loosened the supported fitting and turned the open end toward the listening area. Nib secured it while Lark checked the diagram. One short chime now reached the meeting place. The tube stayed fixed to its bracket; no mysterious sound source had appeared. A cloth shade still covered part of the light window.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write tube beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed sound traveling through the ordinary open tube. The chime was ready. Lark kept the lantern unlit while the shade's snag was inspected beside the new glass.